

Council Meeting
August 13, 2025
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The Claremont City Council held a meeting on Wednesday, August 13, 2025, in the Council Chambers of City Hall.

The meeting was called to order by Mayor Girard at 6:30 p.m.

Members of the Council present:

Ward I Councilor Andrew O’Hearne
Ward II Councilor Brian Zutter
Ward III Councilor Jonathan Hayden
Assistant Mayor Debora Matteau
At-Large Councilor William Greenrose
At-Large Councilor Wayne Hemingway
At-Large Councilor William Limoges (via phone, in a hotel room by himself)
At-Large Councilor Nicholas Koloski
Mayor Dale Girard

Also present:

Nancy Bates, Interim City Manager

AGENDA CHANGES

None.

REPORT OF THE SECRETARY

A motion was made by Councilor Greenrose and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to accept the minutes of the July 23, 2025, City Council meeting.

Roll call:

**Koloski – yes
Greenrose – yes
Limoges - yes
Matteau – yes
Zutter – yes
Hemingway – yes
Hayden – abstain
O’Hearne – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 8-0**

MAYOR'S NOTES

Voting period for biannual City elections, the election will be held on November 4th, the filing period opens September 13th through Friday September 26th.

Claremont Opera House will be presenting Jack and the Beanstalk this Friday morning.

Claremont Parks and Recreation are continuing their entertainment series with wildlife encounters at the Community Center.

Saturday August 23rd The Claremont Senior Center will host their annual car show at the Claremont Speedway between 9am and 2pm.

CITY MANAGER'S REPORT

Washington Street paving and milling are underway in tandem at opposite ends of Washington Street.

North and Main Street will have extended one way traffic. The City anticipates the base layer to be done and lined before winter with paving and planting to be done in the Spring of 2026.

Assistant Director of Public Works, Ted Wadleigh has been asked to speak at the salt symposium representing Claremont as a New Hampshire leader in salt reduction.

Working with Bewith which is our Community Calendar software to implement enhancements.

The White-Water Dam inspection will hopefully be done within a week.

The crack sealing season has been completed.

Pothole in Monadnock park has been fixed.

LWCF Grant for our pickleball and tennis courts at Veteran's Park has a significant amount of residual funding and will soon come to council to discuss what is best to do with the funds.

The relocation project for Taxiway A will start following Labor day weekend and paving is scheduled to begin in October.

The City is finalizing a purchase and sale agreement for 17 Water Street.

Paul Thibodeau the new Chief Building Inspector, was introduced.

Councilor O'Hearne shared concerns for Washington Street such as city staff checking the work being done, drivers avoiding manholes by driving into other lanes, and line markers by Home Depot.

Manager Bates noted the city staff is documenting and going through a checklist and reporting back regularly. As for the manholes and potholes some spots are milled down farther in some areas, these have cones or orange markings on them and will look into the markers.

Councilor Koloski noted a citizen brought to his attention a patch of grass that has been missed for mowing for a while next to CVS where the municipal portion of it is, and was asked to relay this message.

Councilor Koloski noted a couple of businesses reached out in June with concerns to the infrastructure at the intersection of Bowen and Washington, the utility company communication and fiber is resting across the street on the arm of the traffic signal itself and reported this to the Fire Department on June 26 and it still remains in this condition.

Councilor O’Hearne shared additional concerns for vacant lots on Main Street and dirt crossings not being flush with the road that have people coming to a halt on Main Street.

APPOINTMENT TO BOARDS AND COMMITTEES

Frances J Tolles Home

Assistant Mayor Matteau nominated Eric Dean Rouleau and was seconded by Councilor Greenrose.

Councilor Hemingway nominated Gary Raymond and was seconded by Councilor O’Hearne.

Councilor Koloski nominated Vicki Landry and was seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau.

Councilor Hayden nominated Claire Lessard and was seconded by Councilor Zutter.

Roll call:

Koloski – Vicki Landry and Gary Raymond

Greenrose – Eric Dean Rouleau and Gary Raymond

Limoges - Eric Dean Rouleau and Gary Raymond

Matteau – Eric Dean Rouleau and Vicki Landry

Zutter – Eric Dean Rouleau and Claire Lessard

Hemingway – Eric Dean Rouleau and Gary Raymond

Hayden – Eric Dean Rouleau and Gary Raymond

O’Hearne – Eric Dean Rouleau and Gary Raymond

Girard – Eric Dean Rouleau and Gary Raymond

Motion carried 8 -1 (Eric Dean Rouleau) and 7-2 (Gary Raymond)

By consensus Council agrees Eric Dean Rouleau will stay in Seat 3, and Gary Raymond will take over Seat 5.

Fiske Free Library Board of Trustees

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Councilor Limoges to appoint Chiara Tosi-Nelson to Seat A-1 to the Fiske Free Library Board of Trustees.

Councilor O’Hearne recommended city staff not make a recommendation to extend a term.

Councilor Hemingway stated there were several applicants coming forward in October for Fiske Free Library and thinks it would have made sense to hold off.

Roll call:

**Koloski – yes
Greenrose – yes
Limoges - yes
Matteau – yes
Zutter – yes
Hemingway – no
Hayden – yes
O’Hearne – no
Girard – yes
Motion carried 7-2**

Arts, History, and Culture Resources Preservation Commission

A motion was made by Councilor O’Hearne and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to appoint Rachel Lewis to Seat 1 to the Arts, History, and Culture Resources Preservation Commission.

Roll call:

**Koloski – yes
Greenrose – yes
Limoges - yes
Matteau – yes
Zutter – yes
Hemingway – yes
Hayden – yes
O’Hearne – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0**

CITIZEN'S FORUM

Jonathan Nelson, Ward I, is speaking in response to the decision to terminate the 79-E for the property on 31 Myrtle Street at the July 23rd Council Meeting, and believes the Council was provided misinformation, and to clarify the record a letter was submitted, a project timeline, a monthly breakdown of monthly costs, an itemized expense spreadsheet, before and after photos, a letter from the planning and development department confirming the building permit issue has been resolved and a screenshot showing all building permits as completed, a transcript of the July 23rd meeting and is respectfully requesting a reconsideration of the motion and to hold a public hearing at the next Council meeting.

OLD BUSINESS

None.

NEW BUSINESS

Conservation Commission Cat Hole Presentation

Gary Dickerman, Ward III, Chair of the Conservation Commission gave a PowerPoint presentation on the findings from the 2013 Natural Resource Inventory, contracted with Moosewood Ecological, LLC to provide a baseline ecological study of city owned parcels identified as 51-4, 51-2, 61-16, 62-5, and 62-6 this study has been completed and was joined by Jeff Littelton and Steve Lemon in hopes that City leadership will recognize the importance of conserving these parcels and will agree that a long term management plan should be developed to preserve this natural resource.

Rail Trail Draft Engineering Study Presentation – Public Hearing

Chris Turgeon and John Byatt from the BETA Group presented the second presentation for the Rail Trail Draft Engineering Study.

Councilor Greenrose shared concern for the design being on the west side of the road.

Mr. Turgeon noted the location of these designs were outlined in the TAP grant and was instructed to move forward with that location.

Mayor Girard opened a public Hearing.

Mike Sanborn, Ward I, shared his concern for the deck on the bridge. Mayor Girard noted that it was a part of a different project.

Mayor Girard closed the public hearing

Power Investments LLC PILOT Agreement – Public Hearing

City Manager Bates explained this is a second PILOT Agreement for Power Investments, LLC and phase II of their solar installment, the agreement is significantly the same as their first PILOT agreement, and is requesting Council for approval to sign this agreement on behalf of City of Claremont.

Motion to Approve PILOT Agreement

The Claremont City Council, pursuant to RSA 72:74 and after public hearing duly noticed, approves the proposed Payment in Lieu of Tax Agreement (PILOT) between the City and Power Investment, LLC for a renewable solar power electric generating facility located at or near Grissom Road (map 187, lot 5-1) (the Property), and further authorizes the City Manager or his designees to take all such actions as may be necessary to execute said PILOT and implement this motion in accordance with state law and regulation.

A motion was made by Councilor Hayden and seconded by Councilor Koloski to approve the PILOT Agreement with Power Investments, LLC.

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Zutter – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

O’Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 9-0

Ordinance 640 Merit System Amendment to Attachment B Payroll and Human Resources Specialist [Part Time] – First Reading

Human Resources Director, Shannon Thibodeau presented Ordinance 640, and is hoping to post the position by end of week contingent upon Council’s approval as this would help with the recruitment process. Manager Bates added this position was passed with the Budget.

CITY OF CLAREMONT - IN THE YEAR TWO THOUSAND AND TWENTY-FIVE

ORDINANCE #640

Amending the City of Claremont's Merit System – Modification of Grade Classification for Creation of Position of Part-Time Payroll and Human Resources Specialist and Revocation/Replacement of Position of Finance/Human Resources Specialist with Position of Accounting Specialist; Amending the Non-Union Employee Classification Plan

THE CITY OF CLAREMONT ORDAINS:

Pursuant to Article III, Sections 24, 25 and Article IV, Sections 51 and 52, of the Claremont City Charter; the City's Merit System as well as the Non-Union Employee Classification Plan (Attachment B) are hereby amended and readopted as follows:

Section 1. New Position and Compensation Grade for Part-Time Payroll and Human Resources Specialist

A new employment position titled, Part-Time Payroll and Human Resources Specialist, shall be hereby established within the City's Merit System as well as the Non-Union Employee Classification Plan (Attachment B). The rate of compensation to be paid to this position shall be established by such Grade, as provided below, from which the salary range of this position is identified within the Non-Union Employee Pay Schedule at the annualized pay scales as set forth in Attachment C (on file in the City Manager's Office):

Position:

Grade:

Part-Time Payroll and Human Resources Specialist

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Section 2. Revocation/Replacement of Position of Finance/Human Resources Specialist as well as Creation of New Position and Compensation Grade for Accounting Specialist

A new employment position titled, Accounting Specialist, shall be hereby established within the City's Merit System as well as the Non-Union Employee Classification Plan (Attachment B). Contemporaneously with the creation of this new position, the position of Finance/Human Resources Specialist shall be terminated and removed from the City's Merit System as well as the Non-Union Employee Classification Plan (Attachment B). The rate of compensation to be paid to this position (Accounting Specialist) shall be established by such Grade, as provided below, from which the salary range of this position is identified within the Non-Union Employee Pay Schedule at the annualized pay scales as set forth in Attachment C (on file in the City Manager's Office):

Position:

Grade:

Accounting Specialist

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Section 3. Non-Union Employee Classification Plan

The compensation of every non-union employee of the City shall be determined by the classification of the job in which such person is employed and in accordance with Attachments B and C to the City's Merit System (which are on file in the City Manager's Office). Upon adoption of this Ordinance, the new version of the Non-Union Employee Classification Plan (Attachment B), which is an exhibit to this Ordinance, shall be implemented with the proposed changes contained therein and consistent with this legislative act.

Section 4. Prior Enactments Superseded

The Non-Union Employee Classification Plan as adopted by action of the City Council concerning those set forth in Attachment B, prior to adoption of this Ordinance and all prior amendments thereto, are hereby repealed as they pertain to same.

Section 5. Validity

If any article, section, subsection, sentence, clause or phrase of this Ordinance is for any reason held to be unconstitutional or invalid, such decision shall not affect the remaining portions of this Ordinance.

Section 6. Effective Date

This Ordinance shall take effect and be enforced immediately upon passage, but shall be retroactive to the first day of the month in which it is passed upon third reading.

Introduced and passed on first reading _____ 2025.

Considered and passed on second reading _____ 2025.

Considered and passed on third reading by a two-thirds vote _____ 2025.

A motion was made by Councilor Hemingway and seconded by Councilor Koloski to pass Ordinance 640 to a second reading at the August 27th City Council Meeting.

Councilor Hemingway read the explanation of proposed action into the record.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Limoges - yes
Matteau – yes
Zutter – yes
Hemingway – yes
Hayden – yes
O’Hearne – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0

Resolution 2026-13 Use of Capital Reserve for Emergency Replacement of Critical Equipment
Server Room/Phone Room Air Conditioning Units – Public Hearing

City Manager Bates explained there was a failure in the main server room of the Air Conditioning Units and had to shut down some equipment, and authorized the replacement of the main unit to protect the City’s assets and is requesting the Council approve moving funds from the Capital Reserve to cover the costs as it was an unbudgeted item.

A motion was made by Councilor Greenrose and seconded by Councilor Zutter to accept Resolution 2026-13.

Councilor Greenrose read Resolution 2026-13 into the record.

Mayor Girard asked if taking the money out of Capital Reserve would still leave the City in good shape if an emergency happened. Manager Bates relayed it would be okay.

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Roll call:
Koloski – yes
Greenrose – yes
Limoges - yes
Matteau – yes
Zutter – yes
Hemingway – yes
Hayden – yes
O’Hearne – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0

Visitor’s Center Need for Engineering Study Discussion

City Manager Bates and Chief Building Inspector Paul Thibodeau presented the Discussion on the need got an engineering Study on the Visitors Center.

Memorandum

To: Honorable Mayor and Council Members
From: Nancy Bates, Acting City Manager
Date: 2025-08-13
Re: Visitor's Center Discussion

The Mike Satzow Visitor's Center at 14 North Street appears to need some significant attention. What started as concern over the front entry overhung has led to some significant additional observations of issues with this building.

The building appears to be experiencing significant settling, and the following has been observed:

1. A slant in the front entry overhand due to building shift.
2. Significant rot of the supports and sills of the front overhang.
3. A substantial slope in the building foundation from front to back.
4. Significant cracks in exterior and interior walls, as well as the slab foundation.
5. Inoperable windows and doors due to the building settling.
6. An inoperable elevator due to building shift.

These observations cause me concern about the overall condition of the Visitor's Center. I have asked the Chief Building Inspector and the City's Project Manager to engage an appropriate engineer to perform a professional evaluation of the building and make recommendations for remediation of the issues.

The engineering expense is not budgeted, but I feel it is critical to address potential safety issues in a building that houses City employees and sees significant public foot traffic throughout the week.

I have included some pictures with this memo with the intention of starting a conversation. As part of that conversation, I ask the Council to consider potential funding options to pay for the engineering study.

By consensus City Council Agrees to use fund balance for the geotechnical study, and to bring back a resolution at the next City Council meeting.

Sullivan Street Sidewalk Discussion

Manager Bates noted this has been a topic of concern since starting here and is hoping to discuss options to fix the sidewalk area, and bring back a resolution at a future meeting.

The Council discussed options such as a two- tiered sidewalk with a handrail, and the lower sidewalk would meet ADA requirements. Another option was to eliminate the flower box with harsh corners, but if so, a way to address the steep slope. Another option was to mirror the opposite corner, or do all concrete, and anticipating the costs to be around \$30k -\$50K, Manager Bates added there are funds in the TIF District budget.

Assistant Mayor Matteau wants to eliminate the flower box and mirror the other side and put in a rail. Councilor Limoges agrees with Assistant Mayor Matteau, doesn't think the flower box was ever a good idea as other flower boxes in the area haven't done so well.

Councilor Koloski shared concerns for a rail with snow removal and would like to fix this in the most economical way possible.

Councilor Greenrose does not like the idea of a rail and anticipates this being a hazard, and can picture people walking into it he would like to see a solution without tiers.

Councilor Hemingway thinks it would be best to mirror, but doesn't feel that would be the best financial option.

Councilor O'Hearne suggested coming back with three visual options.

By Consensus Council agrees to continue the discussion with visual options at the next City Council Meeting.

31 Myrtle Street Reconsideration

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Koloski to reconsider the 79-E Termination for 31 Myrtle Street.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Limoges - no

Matteau – yes

Zutter – yes

Hemingway – no

Hayden – recuse

O'Hearne – no

Girard – no

Motion failed 4-4

COMMITTEE REPORTS

Councilor Limoges reported the CDA is looking at bids for repairing the 56 Opera House roof.

Assistant Mayor Matteau reported the Planning Board approved a phase II solar array at the wheelabrator plant.

Councilor Heminway reported the ZBA reviewed and approved two in-home businesses (bakery's) and a storage unit request where there will be an onsite visit.

Councilor Hayden stated the EPA Steering Committee is putting together a scope of work for the removal of the power plant and spoke to DES and noted there are delays due to suspect materials and should have a plan within the next three to four weeks. Also adding the Brownfields Walking Tour is tomorrow.

Mayor Girard reported for the Airport and noted there was a potential solar project for a private developer on the closed end of the runway over towards American Brush, Manager Bates is going to meet with them to get what their true interest is.

FUTURE AGENDA ITEMS AND DIRECTIVES

Councilor Koloski asked about a community center task force, Manager Bates responded by stating there are no plans to do this in the immediate future. Councilor Koloski then asked about a housing task force, Manager Bates also does not plan on creating this in the immediate future.

Councilor Koloski shared concern that the Master Plan is outdated. Manager Bates noted this is currently being worked on, and our City Planner has started this project.

Councilor Koloski would like to ensure there will be an educational component for the upcoming proposed charter amendment changes, and asked if everything was on track. Manager Bates will follow up with the City Clerk.

Councilor Koloski asked about a device called the Owl, adding there is one at planning and believes the City purchased one for the Council Chambers and would like an update.

Councilor Koloski also asked about the current permitted taxis in the City.

CONSULTATION WITH LEGAL COUNSEL

None.

ADJOURNMENT

At 9:10 p.m., a motion was made by Councilor O’Hearne and seconded by Councilor Zutter to adjourn.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Zutter – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

O’Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 9-0

Respectfully Submitted,

Julia A. Bizzarro
Clerk to the Council